

OMP-18rev calculated final anchovy TAC for 2025

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The OMP-18rev calculated final Total Allowable Catch (TAC) for South African anchovy for 2025 is 0t. The recent recruitment and biomass estimates for South African anchovy have been extremely low, outside the range of that simulated when OMP-18rev was developed.

Keywords: anchovy, Operational Management Procedure, South Africa, Total Allowable Catch

OMP-18rev (de Moor 2021) can be used to recommend the final 2025 Total Allowable Catch (TAC) for South African anchovy using the following data:

- 1) March/April 2025 survey estimate of anchovy biomass (Coetzee *et al.* 2025a).
- 2) July 2025 survey estimate of anchovy recruitment: 11.6 billion (Coetzee *et al.* 2025a).
- 3) Time after 1 May that the survey commenced: 2.323 months (survey commenced on 11th July)
- 4) Anchovy recruit catch from 1st November to 10th July, using monthly cut-off lengths from de Moor *et al.* (2012) and assuming cut-off lengths of 8.5cm for March to July: 0.263 billion
- 5) Anchovy adult catch from 1st November to 10th July, using monthly cut-off lengths from de Moor *et al.* (2012) and assuming cut-off lengths of 8.5cm for March to July: 0.238 billion
- 6) Directed anchovy TAC for 2024: 140 137t.

As the November 2024 biomass survey was cancelled and replaced with a March/April 2025 survey, a correction factor was applied to convert the later survey biomass into one approximately corresponding to that which would have been surveyed in October/November 2024. Three different November 2024 biomass values were calculated, based off different ratios used to convert the March/April 2025 survey biomass to one which would represent the corresponding biomass which might have been observed in November 2024 (de Moor 2025):

- i) 113 418t using the average ratio (0.98) from the last 10 years;
- ii) 80 095t using the 2nd lowest ratio (0.69) from the last 10 years; and
- iii) 88 462t using the 3rd lowest ratio (0.76) from the last 10 years.

Using even the highest of these three estimates of biomass, the final anchovy TAC calculated by OMP-18rev is 0t (Figure 1). OMP-18rev has also calculated an initial anchovy TAC of 0t (de Moor 2025b), but an interim anchovy TAC of 30 000t had already been awarded given the delayed biomass survey.

de Moor (2025b) noted that the three estimates of biomass above were all below the 2.5%ile of the range simulated when OMP-18rev was developed (Figure 2). In addition, the CVs associated with the estimates of anchovy biomass in 2023 and 2024 were substantially higher than those from 1984-2022 which were used during the MSE for OMP-

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18rev (de Moor 2025b). Figure 3 now shows two of the three most recent anchovy recruitments are below the 10%ile of that simulated during the MSE for OMP-18rev.

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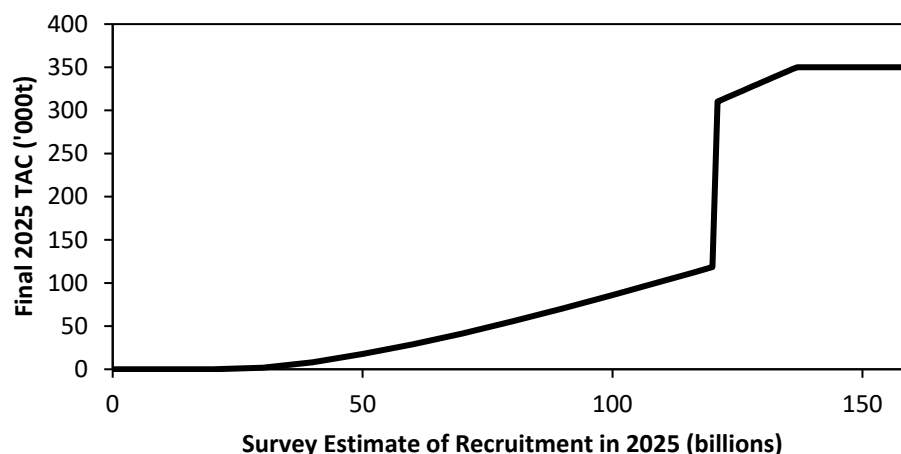


Figure 1. The OMP-18rev calculated final anchovy TAC for 2025 for a range of recruitment estimates, but given the higher of the November 2024 anchovy biomass value (113 418t) and the other data listed in 3)-6) above. The rapid increase around 120 billion recruits is once the projected biomass is no longer projected to be below the Critical Biomass threshold in November 2025.

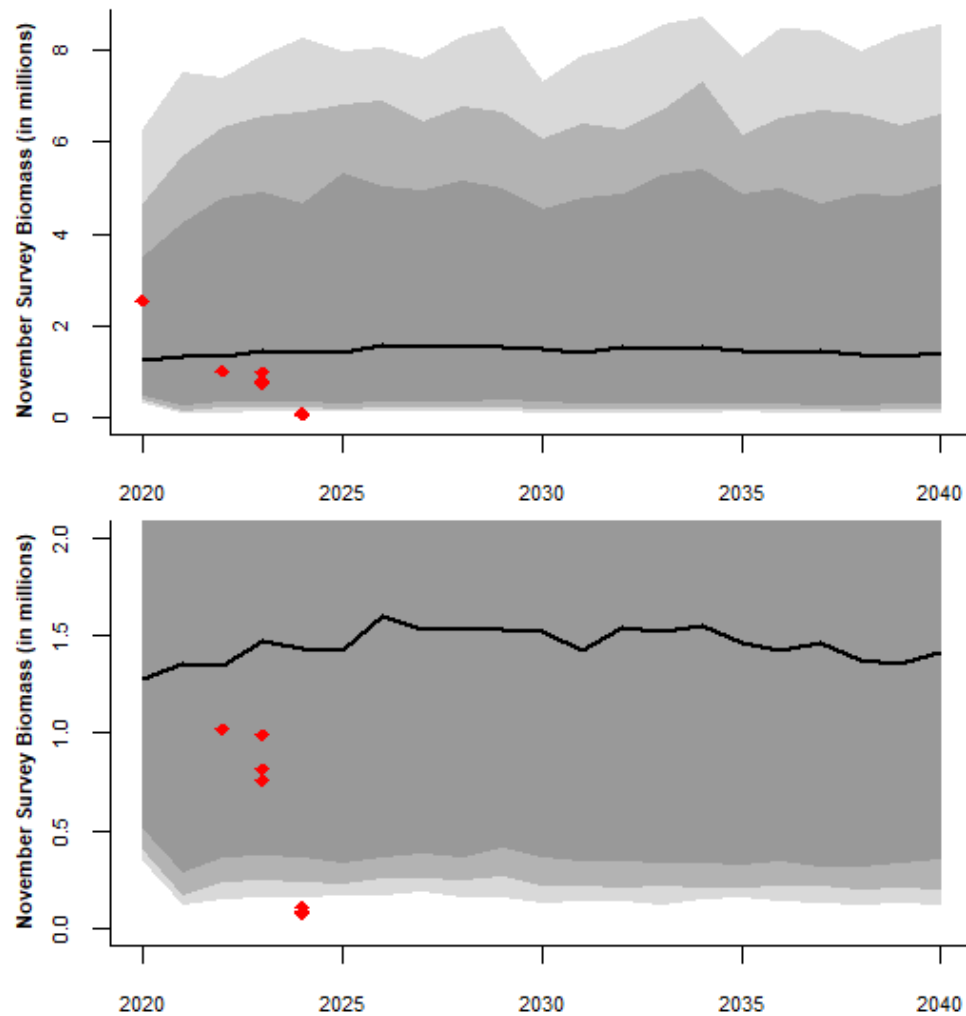


Figure 2. (Figure 1 of de Moor 2025b) An update of Figure C1 from de Moor (2021). Median (black line), 80%ile, 90%ile and 95%ile (in progressively lighter grey colours) probability intervals for November survey estimates of biomass simulated under the base case Operating Model during the development of OMP-18rev. The lower panel is a repeat of the upper panel, but over a smaller vertical axis range to show the lower percentiles more clearly. The red diamonds show realised observations in recent years, with some uncertainty in the most recent two years given the late timing of the survey, but not accounting for the high survey CVs.

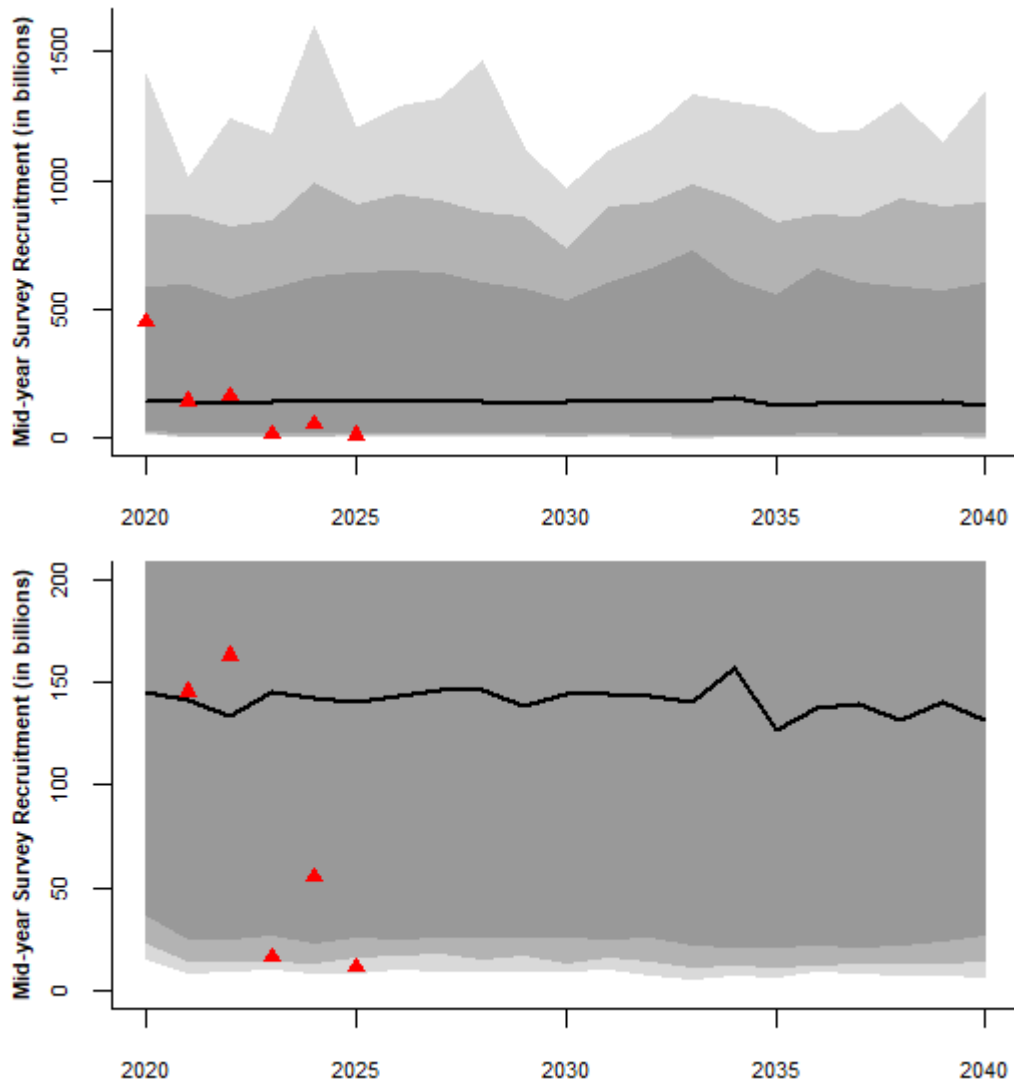


Figure 3. An update of Figure C2 from de Moor (2021). Median (black line), 80%ile, 90%ile and 95%ile (in progressively lighter grey colours) probability intervals for May/June survey estimates of recruitment simulated under the base case Operating Model during the development of OMP-18rev. The lower panel is a repeat of the upper panel, but over a smaller vertical axis range to show the lower percentiles more clearly. The red diamonds show realised observations in recent years.